CONTRACTOR SUPPORT OF U.S. OPERATIONS IN THE USCENTCOM AREA OF RESPONSIBILITY

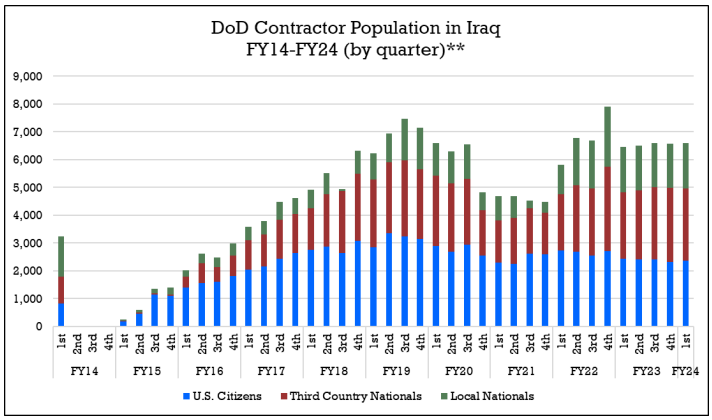
BACKGROUND: This report provides Department of Defense (DoD) contractor personnel numbers for 1st quarter Fiscal Year 2024 (FY24) and the current status of efforts underway to improve management of contractors accompanying United States (U.S.) Forces. It includes data on DoD contractor personnel deployed in Iraq and Syria, Operation Inherent Resolve (OIR), and the U.S. Central Command (USCENTCOM) area of responsibility (AOR).

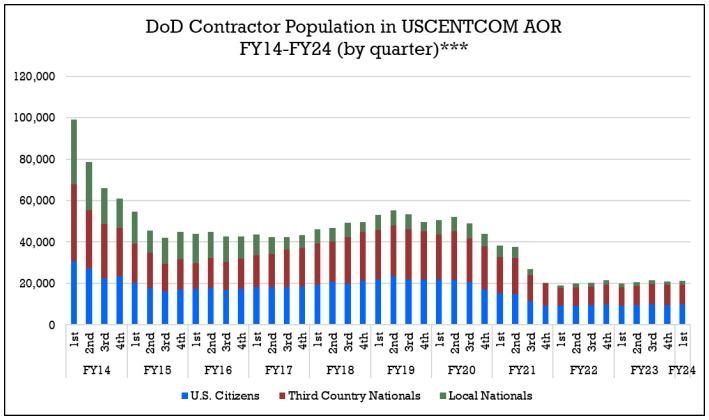
KEY POINTS: During 1st quarter FY24, USCENTCOM reported approximately 21,195 contractor personnel supporting DoD in the USCENTCOM AOR, an increase of approximately 189 from the previous quarter.

DoD Contractor Personnel in the USCENTCOM AOR

	Total Contractors	U.S. Citizens	Third Country Nationals (TCN)	Local Nationals
Iraq and Syria	6,503	2,263	2,595	1,645
Other USCENTCOM Locations	14,692	7,539	6,957	196
USCENTCOM AOR	21,195	9,802	9,552	1,841

DoD Contractor Population Trends (FY14–FY24)*





* To maintain a 10-year quarterly view of contractor populations, the date range has been changed to reflect FY14-FY24 data.

** Information on the contractor population in Syria was incorporated starting 2nd quarter FY18.

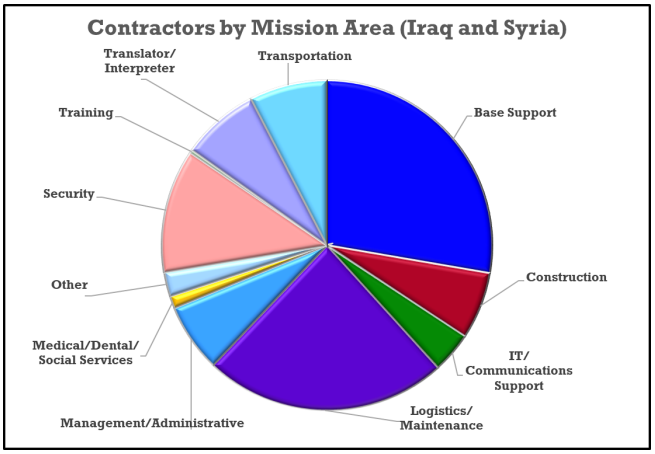
*** Information on the contractor population in Israel is included in the USCENTCOM AOR totals starting in 4th quarter FY21.

Prepared by: ODASD(Log) January 2024

OIR (Iraq and Syria) Summary

- The distribution of contractors in Iraq and Syria by mission category are:

Base Support	1,801	(27.7%)
Construction	429	(6.6%)
IT/Communications Support	260	(4.0%)
Logistics/Maintenance	1,548	(23.8%)
Management/Administrative	436	(6.7%)
Medical/Dental/Social Services	78	(1.2%)
Other	156	(2.4%)
Security	787	(12.1%)
Training	20	(0.3%)
Translator/Interpreter	494	(7.6%)
Transportation	494	(7.6%)
Total:	6,503	



  - Contractor Posture: Approximately 6,503 DoD contractors directly supported DoD-funded contracts in Iraq and Syria. This is a decrease of 0.92% from 4th quarter FY23.

- **USCENTCOM Vendor Threat Mitigation Branch (VTMB):** During this quarter, VTMB reviewed 98 vendors; 58 vendors (59%) were rated an "Acceptable" force protection risk and 40 (41%) were identified as "unacceptable without mitigation". Vendors rated as "unacceptable without mitigation" require completion of a risk mitigation plan or installation access denial letter. VTMB currently has four Section 841 packages in coordination for approval by the Deputy Commander, USCENTCOM.

- **USCENTCOM J43 Operational Contract Support (OCS) Branch:** During the quarter, responsibility for contract support for Camp As Sayliyah, Qatar transitioned from the Army's 408th Contracting Support Brigade to the Department of State (DoS). At the request of the DoS, two Army contracting officer's representatives remained on site until the end of calendar year 2023. The USCENTCOM OCS team held its quarterly Expanded OCS Working Group with members from across the USCENTCOM staff. This event focused on real world planning and support to Israel operations and reinforced the role of the headquarters staff in identifying and planning for commercial support. The working group is focused on improving understanding of OCS, identifying commercial support requirements, and incorporating commercial support into key USCENTCOM plans.

- **Combined Joint Task Force - Operation INHERENT RESOLVE (CJTF-OIR) Operational Contract Support Integration Cell (OCSIC):** During this quarter, the CJTF-OIR OCSIC validated USCENTCOMs $320M annual requirement for the Logistics Civil Augmentation Program, providing base life support services to DoD and coalition personnel in Iraq. Also, because of increased attacks across the combined joint operations area, the OCSIC piloted the first-ever Base Logistics Force Protection Initiative encompassing all operating locations in Iraq and Syria, resulting in the OCSIC validating over $15M in requirements to ensure the safety of assigned personnel. Finally, the OCSIC was integral in future planning operations involving base movements in Syria and the creation of Blanket Purchase Agreements that reduced procurement administrative lead time for reoccurring essential requirements. CJTF-OIR OCSIC spearheaded the Inter Agency Agreement between DoS and

DoD that restored DoS services to the Baghdad Green-Zone following a DoS drawdown following the October 7, 2023, incident in Israel.

IMPROVEMENTS TO MANAGEMENT AND OVERSIGHT OF DOD CONTRACTORS

- **Office of the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Logistics (ODASD(Log)):**
    - **OCS Governance and Oversight.** On November 14, 2023, the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Logistics and the Vice Director for Logistics, Joint Staff (JS J4) co-chaired the 1st quarter FY24 OCS Functional Capabilities Integration Board (FCIB) meeting. The Director for International Cooperation, Assistant Secretary of Defense for Industrial Base Policy, attended as a special guest, sharing insights on how to work more effectively with North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) and allied partners. The U.S. European Command provided an overview of lessons learned focused on OCS and contracting coordination with NATO/host nation partners during Austere Challenge 2023. Additionally, the Department of the Army briefed its Service operating concept, Multi-Domain Operations, and the integration of OCS, into Army operations. Information on efforts to develop the Vendor Threat Mitigation (VTM) program and Joint Operational Contract Support Planning Event were also presented. The Board approved changing the annual DoD OCS Action Plan to a biennial publication in FY25 and closed four completed OCS improvement actions. The next meeting will be held on February 27, 2024.
    - **DoD OCS Training Guidance.** During 1st quarter FY24, ODASD(Log), in coordination with the OCS FCIB, completed development of the Department's enterprise-wide OCS Training Guidance. Currently under review with the Office of the General Counsel, this guidance will support workforce development by recommending appropriate training to improve individual skills and competencies when published in early 2024. It will be complemented by the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff Manual on OCS Education and Training Standards (CJCSM 3502.01), currently pending formal coordination. Both documents will supplement existing DoD policy and doctrine, which directs Military Departments to identify and train personnel for OCS responsibilities and establish requirements for OCS education and training.
    - **Defense Standards for Security Services:**
        - All DoD contracts for private security services require compliance with American National Standard Institute (ANSI) PSC.1-2012 (R2017), "Quality Management Standard for Private Security Company Operations" or International Organization for Standardization (ISO) 18788-2015 "Management Systems for Private Security Operations." All private security companies contracted by DoD at any tier are currently compliant with one or both of the existing standards and have achieved independent third-party certification.
            - The DoD continues to review plans and timelines for companies to transition to the revised standard, ANSI/ASIS PSC.1-2022 "Management System for Private Security Company Operations—Requirements with Guidance."
        - A total of 109 private security companies from 34 different countries have achieved independent third-party certification to one or both standards.
- **JS J45, Operational Contract Support Division (OCSD):**

- **Assessments and Reporting.** J45 OCSD obtained approval of the annual Joint Assessment of Commercial Capabilities. The assessment will serve to justify significant changes to strategic guidance.

- **OCS in Planning.** At a Strategic Planning Framework (SPF) event in College Park, MD, November 28-December 1, 2023, J45 OCSD trained and collaborated with 50 joint planners from the Combatant Commands, Services, and Agencies, to promote successful integration of commercial capabilities into SPF processes.

- **Individual Training.**

  - **Joint OCS Planning and Execution Course (JOPEC).** During the 1st quarter FY24, J45 OCSD trained 50 students, through both remote-learning and in-person JOPEC offerings hosted by Army Sustainment University (ASU) and U.S. Forces Korea.

  - **Joint Enabling Capabilities Command, Joint Planning Support Element (JPSE), Joint Enhanced Training (JET).** J45 OCSD facilitated a JET event for 65 JPSE personnel at Norfolk Naval Base, November 15-16, 2023. The training helping students integrate commercial capabilities into military operations and crisis planning.

  - **Joint Knowledge Online (JKO).** J45 OCSD continues to develop a four-phase suite of training to replace the current Joint OCS Essentials for Commanders and Staff suite. The first two phases are available to students on the JKO platform:

    - OCS I, *Leveraging Commercial Capabilities Across the Competition Continuum*. A total of 1,404 students have completed OCS I to date.
    - OCS II, *OCS Fundamentals*. A total of 450 students have completed OCS II to date.

    The final two phases—OCS III, *Planning and Coordinating Responsibilities for Staffs*, and OCS IV, *Planning and Executing Responsibilities for OCS Practitioners*—are in development.

- **OCS in Joint Education.**

  - **U. S. Africa Command/U.S. European Command Engineer Workshop.** J45 OCSD provided instruction on joint engineering aspects of OCS to 102 attendees on November 29, 2023. Instruction included OCS considerations related to construction standards, environmental planning, and availability of materials and labor.

  - **Joint Logistics Course (JLC), ASU.** J45 OCSD delivered OCS instruction at two sessions of the JLC, on November 3 and December 8, 2023, respectively.

  - **Joint Engineer Operations Course.** On October 31, 2023, J45 OCSD delivered a presentation to 37 operational engineers at the U.S. Army Engineer School.

- **OCS in Exercises.**

  - **Determining Climate Challenges for Defense Logistics Tabletop Exercise (TTX).** J45 OCSD brought commercial capabilities awareness and potential solutions to two Arctic scenarios, extrapolating today's climate conditions, to those expected in 2040. J45 OCSD's involvement in the exercise helped demonstrate that OCS planning and execution could help mitigate competition for predicted scarcer resources resulting from

impacts of climate change. The exercise, sponsored by the Institute for Defense Analyses (IDA), took place October 17-19, 2023.

- **Joint Task Force–Next TTX.** J45 OCSD injected OCS processes and commercial capability considerations in the context of vetting an improved command-and-control (C2) construct during the November 15-16, 2023, exercise facilitated by IDA.
- **Logistics C2/Command Relationships Wargame.** J45 OCSD participated in this multi-vignette wargame set in the U.S. Indo-Pacific Command AOR and sponsored by Systems Planning and Analysis, Inc., on December 12-15, 2023. The wargame challenged participants to consider early commercial contract planning when assessing the effectiveness of existing logistics authorities and C2 structure. J45 OCSD's participation ensured that commercial capabilities were considered in joint task force decision-making and information flow.